Emotional Atlas: Emotional Geometry, Textual Evolution, and Shape-Guided Revision

Technical report on version 0.9.10; November 13, 2026

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Emotional Atlas is a desktop environment for examining emotional movement in literary texts and dream reports. It combines large language model (LLM) inference with locally validated textual evidence, a three-coordinate emotional representation, interactive visualization, geometric construction, and text-order evolution. A separate multilingual idiom workflow proposes direct expressions, transformed expressions, and tentative imagery echoes. An emotional shape-transfer workspace uses the trajectory of a source analysis to guide revision of another text. The system supports conservative editing and a more permissive transformation policy, reports its decisions, and preserves resumable checkpoints. This report describes the implemented algorithms, data flow, operational constraints, and verification of version 0.9.10. The scores and interpretations are model judgments, not established psychometric measurements; software verification does not establish interpretive accuracy or transfer efficacy.

Additional Key Words and Phrases: emotional geometry, text analysis, shape transfer, multilingual idioms, visualization

1 SCOPE AND DESIGN

The application supports exploratory reading and computational experimentation. Its central unit is a text segment: ordinarily a paragraph, optionally a line, or a sentence when granular analysis is enabled. The interface preserves a distinction between source text, inferred emotional descriptions, derived coordinates, and geometric representations. Changing a surface or viewing mode does not change the underlying scores.

The main window contains text input, provider controls, the primary scatter plot, results, and evidence inspection. Expanded plots, solid/evolving objects, and shape transfer use separate windows. Dark mode is the startup default; a Light option changes interface backgrounds and text across open and newly created windows. Valence colors, yellow idiom markers, and user-selected surface colors remain distinct from interface appearance.

This report describes implemented functionality. It does not claim that emotional meaning has a unique geometric form, that a dream image has a determinate symbolic meaning, or that generated revisions preserve facts in flexible mode.

1.1 Research context

Dimensional models provide a research context for emotional coordinates. Russell's circumplex organizes affect around valence and arousal [9], while Bradley and Lang's Self-Assessment Manikin includes pleasure, arousal, and dominance in human ratings [1]. Word-level affective norms from Warriner and colleagues [10] and the NRC VAD lexicon [7] provide empirical reference points. These resources concern annotated stimuli and populations; they do not validate an LLM's scores for a paragraph or a dream. GoEmotions offers a complementary categorical annotation scheme [2], illustrating why categories and continuous dimensions should not be treated as interchangeable measurements.

Reagan and colleagues analyze emotional trajectories in a literary corpus [8]. Their study motivates examining change over text order, but it does not establish universal narrative templates or validate the present segmentation and scoring procedure. PCA summarizes variation through a linear projection [5]; the retained variance and shared projection basis therefore matter when comparing displayed trajectories. Alpha-shape research formalizes families of boundaries constructed from point sets [3]. It offers a geometric comparison for the app's solid-object views, not evidence that a rendered boundary measures emotional meaning or that every surface option implements an alpha shape.

Text style-transfer research separates attribute control from content preservation and fluency [4]. Emotional shape transfer similarly needs separate checks of coordinate agreement, readability, and semantic change, especially when flexible rewriting is enabled. Multilingual idiomaticity benchmarks evaluate expressions in context [6]. Inferring an idiom from dream imagery extends beyond that benchmark setting: an image resembling a literal expression is a hypothesis for reader review, not proof of the dreamer's intention.

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2 ARCHITECTURE AND EXECUTION

The application is written in Python with Tk/ttk. Network inference runs in worker threads, with queued events delivered to the GUI. Geometry and export operations also use background work where implemented. Local plotting, playback, PCA, and saved-result inspection do not require new model requests.

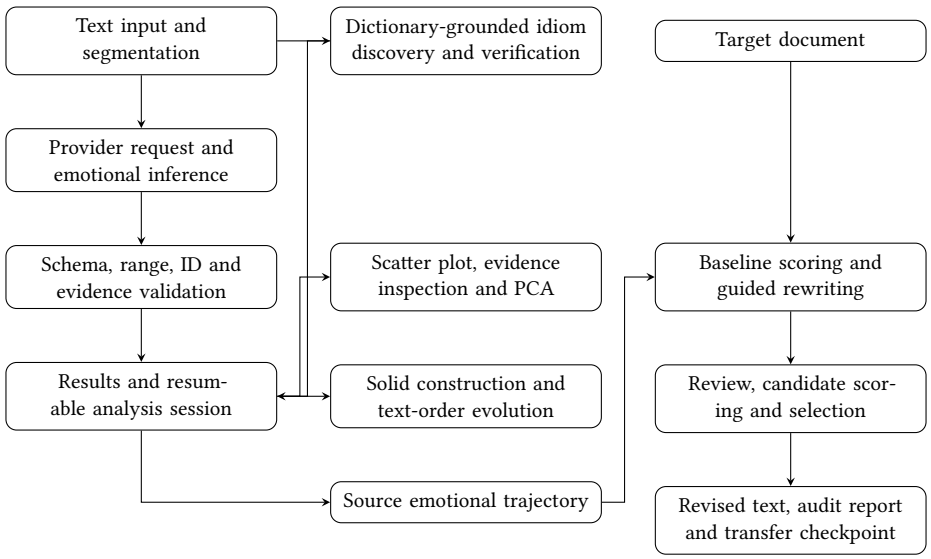


Fig. 1. Emotional Atlas analysis, visualization, idiom, and shape-transfer workflows.

Component	Responsibility
app.py	Main interface, canvas plotting, source/session controls and orchestration
analysis.py	Provider adapters, inference prompt, validation, evidence repair and session serialization
segmentation.py	Local sentence-boundary heuristics
pca.py, playback.py	Standardized PCA and text-order playback
idioms.py, datasets/	Idiom retrieval, verification and dictionary provenance
geometry.py, object_view.py	Solid construction, subdivision, rendering and object export
evolution_export.py	Bounded, cancellable evolution export
shape_transfer.py, transfer_view.py	Trajectory alignment, rewriting, selection and transfer interface
transfer_session.py, session_identity.py	Transfer checkpoints and distinct timestamped session identities
appearance.py	Light/dark interface palette
smoke.py, test_*.py	Offline native checks and automated regression tests

The configured OpenAI adapter uses the Responses API and model identifier gpt-6-luna. VT ARC uses a Chat Completions-compatible endpoint, defaults to gpt-oss-120b, and permits a user-specified model identifier. These are software configuration values, not guarantees of provider availability. The application does not silently substitute another model. Transfer uses the source analysis's provider/model to reduce one source of scoring inconsistency.

Model judgments are checked locally against the source text before eligible segments enter the geometry. These checks establish consistency with the expected response structure and quoted evidence; they do not establish psychometric accuracy.

3 EMOTIONAL INFERENCE AND EVIDENCE

3.1 Representation

For segment i, the model returns intensity I_i in [0,1], valence V_i in [-1,1], and direction D_i in [-1,1] or an unknown value. Intensity denotes strength of feeling rather than physical activity or arousal. Valence runs from unpleasant to pleasant. Direction runs from inward/self-focused to directed toward another person, object, or the world.

The response also contains tone, an ordinal uncertainty judgment, a summary, and up to five emotional experiences. Each experience identifies an experiencer, target where supported, emotional scores, explanations, and evidence. Opposing feelings can remain separate even when net valence is near zero. Low/medium/high uncertainty is not a calibrated probability.

The prompt asks the model to distinguish expressed emotion from negated, hypothetical, quoted, or merely mentioned emotion and to consider metaphor, irony, and speaker changes. These are instructions to the model, not demonstrated guarantees.

3.2 Validation and recovery

Local validation checks response structure, IDs, numeric ranges, directional consistency, and evidence correspondence. Evidence must resolve to source wording; limited normalization accommodates formatting differences without introducing fuzzy semantic matching. Signal words must be supported by the quoted evidence. Nearby context is supplied for interpretation but is not a valid substitute for evidence in the target segment.

Ordinary analysis batches contain up to six units under an 18,000-character target-text budget. An individual oversized unit can exceed that batching budget, subject to the analysis unit limit. Neighboring context is bounded to 1,200 characters on each side. The system therefore does not maintain complete book-length context.

Valid results are retained when a neighboring segment fails. Failed evidence may be repaired through source-word selection. Passage-specific response or repair failures are marked for review and processing continues. Provider, account, transport, or certificate failures stop the run rather than being misclassified as textual failures. Stop is cooperative; an active network request can take up to its 150-second timeout to return. No fallback emotional scores are fabricated.

3.3 Segmentation

Sentence analysis is opt-in. The local heuristic recognizes common English, Arabic, and Chinese terminal punctuation, selected abbreviations, decimal patterns, and closing punctuation. It is not a trained multilingual sentence parser. Dialogue, unusual abbreviations, poetry, and punctuation-free text can be segmented imperfectly. Changing analysis granularity starts a separate analysis; saved metadata identifies the segmentation mode even where legacy fields retain names such as paragraphs.

4 EMOTIONAL GEOMETRY AND PCA

The primary plot places each eligible text segment at a point with three coordinates. The horizontal x coordinate is valence, ranging from unpleasant (-1) to pleasant (+1). The y coordinate is emotional direction, ranging from inward or self-focused (-1) to directed toward another person, object, or the world (+1). The z coordinate represents emotional intensity: the original intensity score is doubled and then reduced by one, so an intensity of 0 appears at -1, an intensity of 0.5 at 0, and an intensity of 1 at +1.

This conversion puts all three display axes on the same numeric range without changing the ordering of intensity scores. Equal axis ranges are a modeling convention, not an empirically established equality of emotional distances. Point color normally represents valence; an idiom annotation can instead mark a point in yellow.

Unknown direction is not replaced with zero. Such segments remain available in the results but lack a full 3D coordinate and are excluded from geometry. Thus an empty original-target plot does not by itself establish emotional neutrality: it can indicate unsupported direction. Identical coordinates can also overlap.

PCA operates on the three existing scores, not on text embeddings. Each nonconstant feature is centered and divided by its sample standard deviation. A Jacobi eigendecomposition of the resulting 3-by-3 covariance matrix supplies components and explained-variance ratios. Constant features contribute zero. At least three eligible segments and nonzero variation are required. Retaining all three PCs preserves the variance of these three inputs; it does not preserve every semantic feature of the text. Component signs are conventional, and nearly equal eigenvalues can make individual axes unstable.

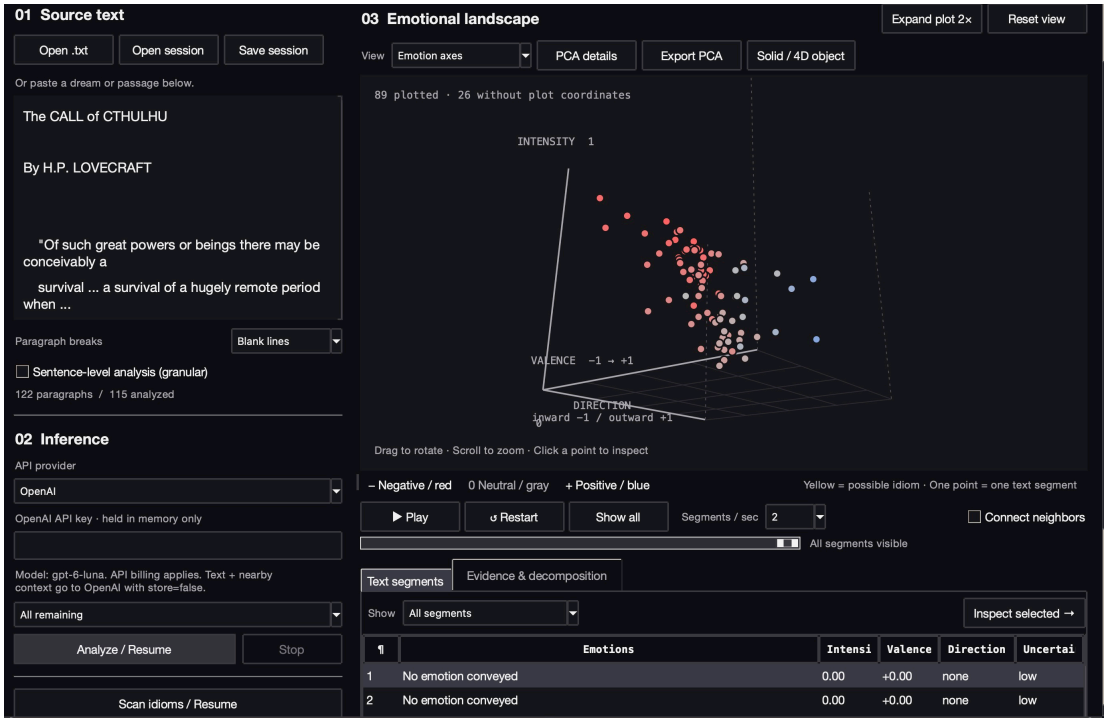


Fig. 2. Saved analysis of The Call of Cthulhu, with 89 plotted paragraphs and 26 analyzed paragraphs lacking plot coordinates. Point colors encode valence.

The evolving-object view fits PCA once to its full snapshot and retains the same basis and display scale across frames. This avoids apparent motion caused solely by refitting the coordinate system at each time step.

5 SOLID OBJECTS, CURVED SURFACES AND EVOLUTION

Three constructions are implemented:

1. **Outermost points:** the convex hull of unique eligible points. It encloses the sample but fills gaps and concavities.
2. **Spatial neighbors:** a 3D Delaunay tetrahedralization filtered by a maximum-edge-length threshold. Exterior faces of retained tetrahedra form the surface. This is a specific thresholded tetrahedral construction, not a general claim to recover the text's intrinsic topology. It may produce disconnected components, cavities or nonmanifold contacts.
3. **Text-order tube:** polygonal rings swept along consecutive emotional positions, with caps on connected runs. Missing coordinates break the path. Thickness is user-controlled, and crossings or tight bends can self-intersect; tube volume is not claimed.

Coplanar or collinear samples do not define a full-dimensional hull. The interface explains such cases instead of inventing thickness. NumPy and SciPy provide numerical operations and hull/tetrahedral computations.

One to three Loop subdivision steps create tessellated approximations to curved surfaces from suitable closed manifold control meshes. Each step replaces a triangle with four and updates vertices through weighted neighbor averages. Smoothing generally rounds and shrinks a shape: a smoothed hull need not contain every source point. Area and eligible volume are recomputed from the resulting mesh. A single chosen surface color is shaded to convey depth; OBJ export includes a corresponding MTL file.

The fourth coordinate is normalized text order:

$$\tau_i = \frac{i-1}{N-1},$$

with zero used for a one-unit text. Cumulative evolution includes eligible points through i; moving-window evolution includes positions $\max(1, i-w+1)$ through i. Missing coordinates still occupy timeline positions. The displayed sequence is a family of 3D slices S_i, conceptually defining:

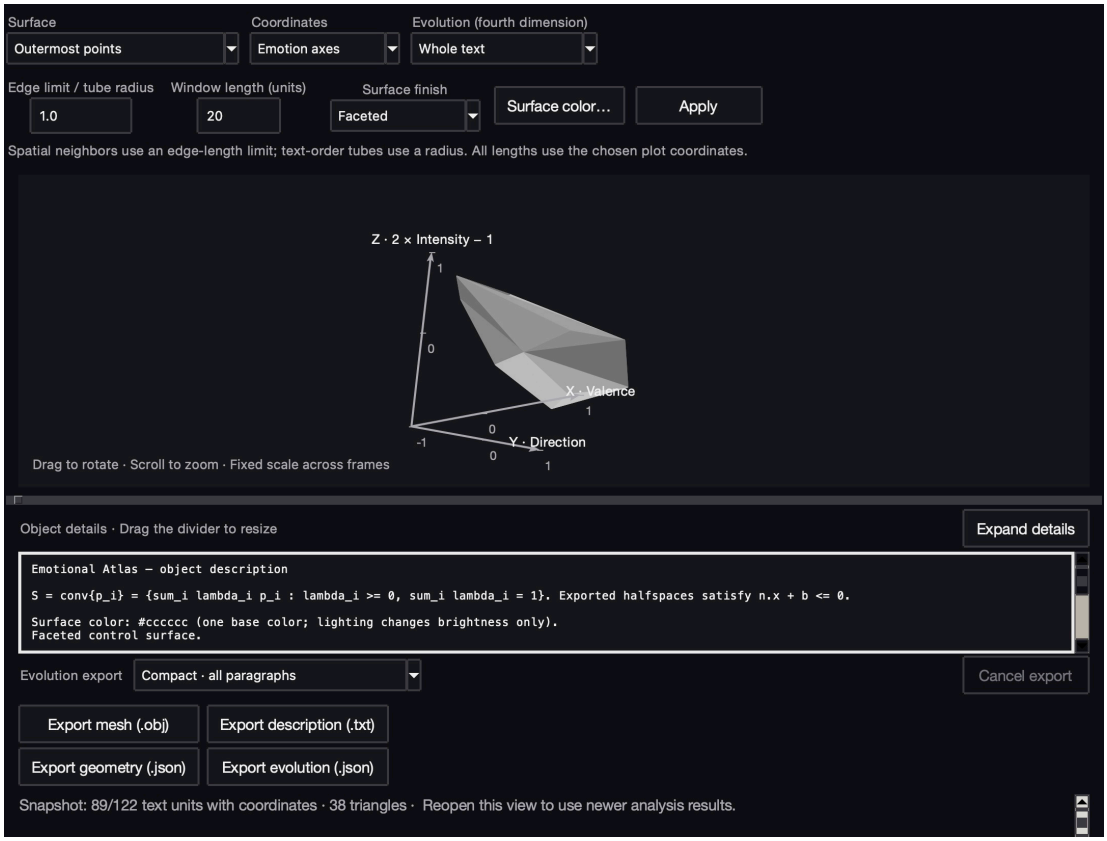


Fig. 3. Solid-object window showing the outermost-point surface, labeled emotional axes, mathematical description, and export controls for the saved analysis.

$$W = \bigcup_{i=1}^{N-1} S_i \times [\tau_i, \tau_{i+1}),$$

plus the final slice at the endpoint. This is text-order evolution, not elapsed reading time or a projected 4D convex hull. Topology can change between slices, and unmatched vertices are not interpolated.

6 MULTILINGUAL IDIOMS AND DREAM IMAGERY

Idiom scanning is a separate workflow. It distinguishes possible direct use, transformed expressions, and imagery echoes. One request proposes canonical expressions; local retrieval grounds candidates in available dictionary entries; a subsequent request verifies retrieved candidates against the passage. Known dictionary IDs and source quotes are checked locally.

The bundled inventory contains 20 English and 10 Arabic starter expressions with project-authored glosses, plus 30,895 Chinese records adapted from pwxcoo/chinese-xinhua, revision fe6d6c2e8baa82187f4c96bbe042e43f96c05666. Its MIT license and attribution are retained in the repository. Inventory size does not measure detection accuracy. English/Arabic coverage is preliminary; dialect variation and Chinese traditional/simplified normalization remain limitations. Imported dictionaries extend coverage and must supply IDs, language, phrase, meaning, source and license metadata.

An image such as someone taking a goat could be proposed as an echo of “get your goat,” but lexical overlap or an object alone is insufficient proof. Alternative readings are presented. These annotations are interpretive hypotheses, not explanations of a dreamer’s mental state. ChengyuBench is identified in project documentation as a potential evaluation resource; it is not bundled or used to establish the system’s accuracy.

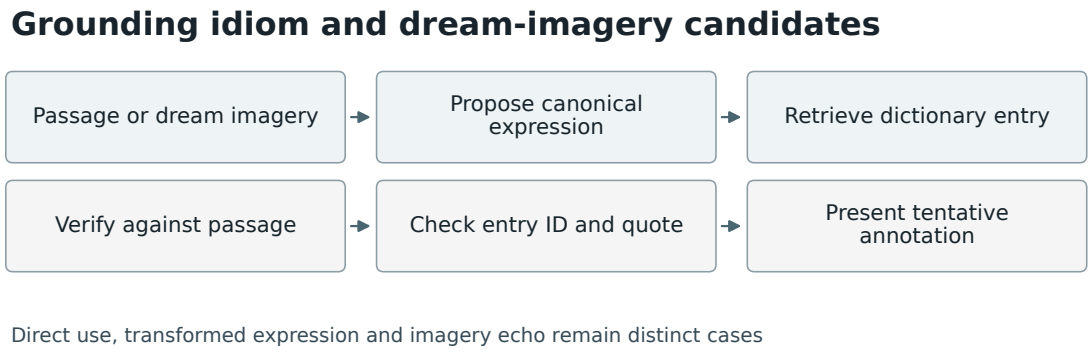


Fig. 4. Idiom workflow. A literal image alone is not proof of an idiom; retrieved expressions and quoted evidence support hypotheses with alternative readings.

7 EMOTIONAL SHAPE TRANSFER

7.1 Alignment and objective

Transfer snapshots the source analysis directly from memory. No mesh export is required. It uses the raw emotional trajectory, not PCA coordinates, a convex hull, Loop-smoothed surface, or chosen surface color.

Known source coordinates form a piecewise-linear trajectory $p(t)$ over normalized source-unit positions. Gaps are interpolated and positions beyond the known range clamp to the nearest endpoint. A target with M processing units samples $t_j = (j-1)/(M-1)$; a one-unit target samples $t = 0.5$. With baseline target point b_j and strength s:

$$q_j = (1 - s)b_j + s\,p(t_j).$$

If the baseline lacks a supported direction, the complete baseline point is unavailable and q_j is set to $p(t_j)$. Candidate distance is:

$$e_j = \frac{\|c_j - q_j\|_2}{2\sqrt{3}}.$$

This normalizes distance by the cube diagonal. It is not a calibrated measure of literary quality. Resampling trajectories does not guarantee equal hulls, volume, or topology.

7.2 Generation, review and selection

The workflow scores the original target, generates a revision, reviews it, scores the candidate without supplying desired coordinates to the scorer, and finally scores the assembled result in its revised neighboring context. One or two revision attempts can be selected. A second attempt receives feedback from the first. The original, requested, and revised trajectories are displayed separately.

Flexible transformation, the default, permits substantial changes to imagery, perspective, emotional reactions, supporting details and local events. The review asks whether the result remains coherent, readable and recognizably related to the target. Meaning and numeric changes are disclosed rather than used as automatic vetoes. Among reasonable scored revisions actually generated, the closest is selected—even if the original scored closer. This policy favors transformation but cannot promise improvement or factual fidelity.

Preserve meaning requires a review with no semantic concerns, unchanged numeric content under the local check, supported direction, and a lower distance than the current best. The original or a prior accepted candidate remains when no candidate qualifies. Neither policy is a global optimization procedure or a guarantee of an exact emotional match. The reviewer and scorer can share model biases; a separate API call does not constitute independent human validation.

7.3 Long documents, boundaries and failures

There is no fixed document-length or unit-count cap in transfer preparation. Oversized units are divided internally into passages of at most 3,000 characters, preferring sentence boundaries and then whitespace. Target request batches use up to six units and a 6,000-character text budget; surrounding context and structured metadata add to actual request size. Users load and export one document. Original separators are retained between spans; replacement text can introduce additional sentence or paragraph boundaries within a span. The entire replacement is scored under its original ID. A subsequent sentence-level reanalysis may therefore produce a different number of points.

A normal one-attempt batch uses approximately five model calls before correction, retries or failure isolation; two attempts add another rewrite/review/scoring cycle. Long documents can require substantial time and API usage. Completed-response usage counters can undercount requests whose responses were interrupted or rejected before accounting was returned.

Passage-specific failures trigger bounded batch isolation. Persistently failing passages are flagged, retaining the original or an accepted earlier revision, and later passages continue automatically. Final-scoring failures preserve the revision but leave its earlier score provisional. Report records distinguish these failures from completed verification. Provider/transport failures and explicit cancellation still stop processing.

8 PERSISTENCE AND EXPORTS

Artifact	Purpose and contents
Analysis session (emotion-atlas-v1)	Source text, segmentation, provider/model, results, reviews, idioms, usage, stable session ID/name and creation/save timestamps
Score CSV / PCA JSON	Tabular scores or PCA coordinates and transform metadata; not full resumable analysis sessions
Object OBJ/MTL, TXT, JSON	Mesh/material, mathematical description, source mapping and construction parameters; static JSON format emotional-atlas-object-v1
Evolution JSON	emotional-atlas-evolution-v2; complete timeline and reconstruction data, optionally sampled meshes
Revised TXT / transfer audit JSON	Selected text; or emotional-atlas-transfer-v1 with attempts, reviews, errors, scores, policy and usage
Transfer checkpoint	emotional-atlas-transfer-session-v1; source snapshot, target/settings, completed work, errors, usage, identity and completion state for later resumption

Transfer checkpoints can be saved during processing and reopened without an active source session. They exclude in-flight work and unfinished batches, which may need to run again. Completed rewrites and final scores are skipped on resume. Saves use a temporary file followed by atomic replacement so failed writes do not overwrite the prior checkpoint. This is manual checkpointing, not continuous autosave.

Compact evolution export avoids calculating meshes and retains complete reconstruction data. Sampled-mesh export is capped at 60 frames, 1,500 source points per sampled frame, 20,000 triangles per frame, and 250,000 triangles overall. It streams output and retains at most one calculated mesh at a time. Export pauses playback and supports cancellation; a native triangulation must finish before cancellation can take effect. Current evolution exports leave hypervolume uncomputed rather than running every slice merely to obtain that scalar.

9 PRIVACY, DEPENDENCIES AND DISTRIBUTION

API keys are held in process memory and excluded from app-generated sessions, checkpoints and exports. Text and bounded context are sent to the selected inference provider; OpenAI requests set store=false. This setting alone is not a statement about

every provider retention policy. Local artifacts contain original text, generated drafts, evidence and potentially sensitive analysis and should be handled accordingly. No analytics or automatic cloud session storage is implemented.

The source dependencies include Python/Tk, NumPy 2.5.4 and SciPy 1.17.1. Packaging uses PyInstaller 6.22.3 with the pinned build requirements. The macOS distribution targets Apple Silicon and macOS 15 or later. Deployment-target inspection is performed on bundled native binaries; native testing was performed on the build host, not on every supported macOS version. There is no packaged Intel release in this version.

The release workflow builds the app, verifies its signature and native deployment targets, runs an offline native smoke test, checks provider connectivity without doing paid text inference, submits the archive to Apple's notarization service, staples an accepted ticket, verifies Gatekeeper assessment, and regenerates the ZIP checksum. Apple notarization addresses distribution checks, not the scientific validity of the application.

Apple accepted the v0.9.10 submission (0e9fddd1-f38c-4df4-9913-52fab7f86239); ticket stapling and validation succeeded, and Gatekeeper assessed the application as an accepted Notarized Developer ID app. All 106 inspected Mach-O binaries met the arm64/macOS deployment-target checks. Provider connectivity checks reached the services without credentials (HTTP 401/403); these establish connectivity, not authenticated inference access.

10 VERIFICATION AND RESEARCH LIMITATIONS

For this release, **93 automated tests passed**. Offline native smoke tests exercise startup, controls, plots, idiom annotations, geometry/evolution exports, shape transfer and checkpoint reopening. Additional native checks verified saving during an active simulated transfer and switching Light/Dark appearance across existing and newly opened windows while retaining data colors. The tests use synthetic fixtures and mocked model responses; no benchmark of live-model interpretation or revision quality is claimed.

Geometric fixtures include known-volume shapes, degenerate inputs, neighborhood thresholds and moving windows. Transfer tests cover interpolation, candidate selection, strict/flexible policies, changes in sentence boundaries, long-text assembly, automatic failure continuation, checkpoint validation, atomic saves and resumption. These tests establish specified software behavior under their fixtures, not universal correctness.

A rigorous future evaluation should measure: inter-reader agreement on emotional coordinates; stability across repeated model runs and providers; native-speaker idiom precision/recall with literal-negative controls; sensitivity to segmentation and geometry parameters; transfer-distance change alongside human judgments of coherence and semantic change; and runtime/API cost across document lengths. Source and target alignment, missing direction, sparse source analyses, prompt sensitivity, model self-evaluation, and limited multilingual starter coverage are material sources of uncertainty.

Emotional Atlas should therefore be understood as an inspectable experimental instrument for reading and transformation. Its strongest technical commitments are traceable source evidence, explicit geometric definitions, visible selection policies, and exportable records—not objective measurement of a person's emotions.

11 IMPLEMENTATION REFERENCES

The report corresponds to version 0.9.10 in this repository. Primary implementation and operational documentation:

- Inference and validation, PCA, and segmentation.
- Geometry implementation and solid/evolving-object guide.
- Idiom implementation, idiom data and limitations, and third-party notices.
- Shape-transfer engine, transfer guide, and checkpoint implementation.
- Native smoke checks, release workflow, and release history.

SUGGESTED CITATION

William Taggart. 2026. Emotional Atlas: Emotional Geometry, Textual Evolution, and Shape-Guided Revision. Technical report on software version 0.9.10. Modern and Classical Languages and Literatures, Virginia Tech. November 13, 2026. https://github.com/FL2744/Emotional-Atlas

AI-USE DISCLOSURE

This project was created with assistance from GPT-6 Astra and Codex. AI tools supported software development, testing, and drafting and revision of this technical report. William Taggart is responsible for the research decisions and final software and documentation. AI assistance does not constitute independent validation of the implementation or its scientific claims; the verification evidence and limitations are stated separately in this report.

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